

This Patient Group Direction (PGD) is intended only for registered healthcare professionals who have been named and authorised by their organisation to practice under it.

Patient Group Direction

for the administration of Amlodipine 5mg/10mg tablets for the treatment of Hypertension

Summary of NICE / NICE CKS Guidelines for Hypertension

NICE Guidelines: Hypertension (NG136)

- **Diagnosis and Staging:** Blood pressure is staged 1-4 based on clinic BP and ABPM/HBPM (Automated/Home Blood Pressure Monitoring). Confirm diagnosis using ABPM or HBPM in most cases.
- **CVD Risk Assessment:** All patients with hypertension should have CVD risk assessment and modification as part of treatment.
- **Target Blood Pressure:** For most patients: <140/90 mmHg clinic BP. For patients aged 80 years and over: <150/90 mmHg. For those with diabetes: <140/90 mmHg (individualised to <130/80 mmHg if tolerated).
- **Lifestyle Advice:** Weight loss, reduced salt intake, regular exercise, reduced alcohol, healthy diet. Non-drug treatment is first-line for stage 1 hypertension.

Amlodipine as First-Line Agent

- **First-line in:** Patients aged >55 years or patients of Black African/Caribbean origin (all ages). ACE inhibitors are preferred in younger patients and those with diabetes.

Patient Group Direction

for the supply/administration of

Amlodipine 5mg/10mg tablets

for the treatment of

Hypertension

Healthcare professionals covered and training

	Healthcare professionals allowed to work under this PGD and requirements
Qualifications and Registration	• Pharmacist registered and practicing with the GPhC • Pharmacy technician registered and practicing with the GPhC
Training and assessment	Pharmacists and Pharmacy Technicians must have completed training relevant to this condition to use this PGD. This training will be documented and overseen by the Get Real Health team. • All users must be familiar with the SPC for the products as well as BNF advice and any applicable national guidelines

	• All users must previously have used PGDs to supply medication • Must work in compliance with the SOPs of their own employer • All users must have appropriate indemnity in place to cover this service
Further training and responsibilities	• All users must be up to date with CPD requirements and appraisal • All users must be up to date with MHRA and safety alerts with regards to medical products • All users must understand the concepts of capacity and consent and be aware of the Mental Capacity Act 2005.

PGD Indication	Hypertension requiring pharmacological management in patients aged 18 years and over
Inclusion criteria	Aged 18 years and over Confirmed diagnosis of hypertension (Stage 1-4) If BP target not achieved with lifestyle modification alone Suitable for first-line therapy: aged >55 years, OR Black African/Caribbean descent
Exclusion criteria	Known hypersensitivity to amlodipine or other dihydropyridine calcium channel blockers Severe aortic stenosis Cardiogenic shock Unstable angina Pregnancy or breastfeeding Severe hepatic impairment (Child-Pugh C)
Cautions	Heart failure (especially decompensated) Hepatic impairment (adjust dose if moderate impairment) Severe renal impairment Diabetes mellitus (may affect blood glucose control) Hypertrophic cardiomyopathy Left ventricular outflow obstruction Patients with coronary artery disease (may cause reflex tachycardia)
Actions if patient is excluded or declines treatment	Advise on alternative treatment options and how these can be accessed. Document any advice given and the decision reached. Inform or refer to the GP as appropriate.

Details of the medicine

Name, form and strength of medicine	Amlodipine 5mg and 10mg tablets
Legal category	POM
Storage	Store below 25°C in a dry place, protected from light
Route/method of administration	Oral, swallowed whole with water
Dose and frequency	Start: 5mg once daily Increase to 10mg once daily if target blood pressure not achieved after 4 weeks Take at the same time each day
Quantity to be administered and/or supplied	28 tablets per month
Maximum or minimum treatment period	Ongoing; review blood pressure control at 4-weekly intervals until target BP achieved, then 6-monthly review
Adverse effects	Common: Peripheral oedema (legs/feet), flushing, headache, dizziness Uncommon: Fatigue, palpitations, tachycardia, dry mouth, nausea, abdominal pain, insomnia, mood changes Rare: Myocardial infarction (angina may improve or worsen), arrhythmias, alopecia, photosensitivity

Yellow card reporting	Report suspected adverse effects via https://yellowcard.mhra.gov.uk and inform the GP as appropriate.
Records to be kept	Record the following information: • that valid informed consent was given • name of individual, address, date of birth and GP • name of healthcare practitioner • name and brand of medication • date of supply dose, form and route quantity supplied • advice given, including advice given if excluded or declines treatment • details of any adverse drug reactions and actions taken supplied via PGD Records should be signed and dated. All records should be clear, legible and contemporaneous. Electronic records can be made. A record of all individuals receiving treatment under this PGD should also be kept for audit purposes as follows: • Adults aged 18 years and over - keep records for 8 years

	Children aged under 18 years - keep records until the 25th birthday (if the patient was 17 years when treatment was finished, keep records until the 26th birthday)
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Patient information

Written information to be given to patient or carer	Supply the patient information leaflet (PIL) provided with amlodipine tablets.
Follow-up advice to be given to patient or carer	Take the tablet at the same time each day, preferably in the morning Do not stop the medication without consulting your doctor Report persistent leg swelling, dizziness, headaches, or palpitations to your doctor Maintain lifestyle modifications: reduce salt, lose weight if overweight, exercise regularly, limit alcohol, reduce caffeine Keep a record of home blood pressure readings if possible Avoid grapefruit juice as it may increase amlodipine levels and side effects Inform healthcare professionals (dentists, nurses) that you are taking amlodipine Attend all follow-up appointments for blood pressure monitoring

Key references

- NICE Medicines Practice Guideline 2 (MPG2): Patient Group Directions. Published March 2017 https://www.nice.org.uk/guidance/mg2 - NICE MPG2 Patient group directions: competency framework for health professionals using patient group directions. Updated March 2017 https://www.nice.org.uk/guidance/mpg2/resources - NICE CKS Guidance: Hypertension NICE NG136 - British National Formulary (BNF) Key information on the selection, prescribing, dispensing and administration of medicines
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Agreement to practise by the Registered Healthcare Professional

By signing this PGD you are confirming that you agree to its contents and that you will work within it. PGDs do not remove inherent professional obligations or accountability. It is the responsibility of each healthcare professional to practise only within the bounds of their own competence and professional code of conduct.

Name and address of pharmacy premises / clinic premises to which this PGD relates			

Name of healthcare professional	Job title	Registration number	Signature
Valid from date	Expiry date		
1/11/25	31/10/26		

PGD adoption and authorisation by the employer/clinical lead

The employer has ensured that the person using this PGD, has the knowledge and skills to safely provide the service which will encompass the supply or administration of a medication or medicine.

This section must be signed by the superintendent or clinical lead responsible for this service.

Name of superintendent / clinical lead	Job title & name of organisation	Signature	Date
Name of professional group signatory	Job title & name of organisation	Signature	Date

Signed on behalf of Get Real Health

Name	Qualification	Signature	Date
Nitin Shori	Medical Doctor GMC: 6047293		2/11/25
Chris Pilkington	Pharmacist GPhC: 2046322		2/11/25

Change history

Version number	Change details	Date
001	Development & issue of new PGD	1st November 2025